



A Vision 2030 Flagship Project



# National Drought Management Authority

## Kajiado County

### Drought Early Warning Bulletin for April 2026

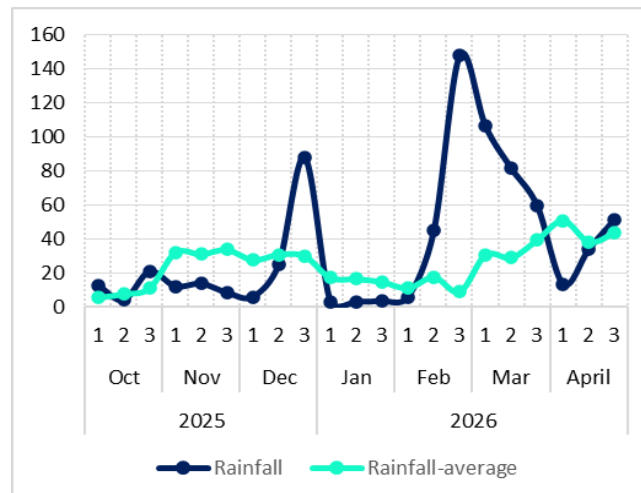
| APRIL DEW PHASE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Early Warning Phase Classification      |            |                |     |                  |  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------|-----|-----|-----|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------|----------------|-----|------------------|--|
| <div>Drought Status: NORMAL</div> <div></div> <div>Shughuli za kawaida</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | LIVELIHOOD ZONE                         |            | EW PHASE       |     | TRENDS           |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | PASTORAL                                |            | NORMAL         |     | STABLE           |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | AGRO-PASTORAL                           |            | NORMAL         |     | STABLE           |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | MIXED FARMING                           |            | NORMAL         |     | STABLE           |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | COUNTY                                  |            | NORMAL         |     | STABLE           |  |
| <div>Drought Situation &amp; EW Phase Classification</div> <div>Biophysical Indicators</div> <div>✓ The onset was earlier than normal in mid-February, April had uneven distribution, amount 74.7% of LTA, cessation expected in late May. The County vegetation condition is above normal.</div> <div>✓ Forage condition is 76.2% good and 23.8 fair across the county while water availability was adequate.</div> <div>Socio Economic Indicators (Impact Indicators)</div> <div>Production Indicators</div> <div>✓ Livestock body condition improving, 66.7% good, 33.3% fair</div> <div>✓ Average milk production improved but still below five-year average.</div> <div>✓ Crop condition is good to fair, bean flowering, maize tasseling.</div> <div>Access indicators</div> <div>✓ Distances to water sources for both domestic and livestock reduced below normal range.</div> <div>✓ Milk consumption improved, but still below normal range, 64% of milk produced is sold. The terms of trade slightly reduced but within normal range due to increase in maize prices against modest increase in goat prices.</div> <div>Utilization Indicators</div> <div>✓ The risk of malnutrition for children improved within normal range. Coping strategy improved, reducing below LTA but within normal range. Food consumption score improved with 79% in acceptable category but 1.4% still in poor category.</div> |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Biophysical Indicators                  |            | Observed Value |     | Normal Range/LTA |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Rainfall (% of Normal)                  |            | 74.7%          |     | 98.987           |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | 3-monthly VCI                           |            | 66.62          |     | >=35             |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Pasture condition                       |            | Good - Fair    |     | Good             |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | State of water                          |            | Good           |     | Fair - Good      |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Production Indicators                   |            | Observed LBS   |     | Normal Range     |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Livestock body condition                |            | 3 - 4          |     | 3 - 5            |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Milk production                         |            | 2.5 lt         |     | 2.3 lt – 3.0 lt  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Livestock migration                     |            | None           |     | None             |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Livestock deaths                        |            | None           |     | None             |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Access Indicators                       |            | Observed Value |     | Normal Range     |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Terms of trade (kg of maize for a goat) |            | 102.8          |     | 81.4 – 117.7     |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Milk consumption                        |            | 1.6 lt         |     | 1.7 lt - 2.3 lt  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Distance to water sources               | Livestock  | 2.4 km         |     | 3.5 km – 5.1 km  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          |                                         | Domestic   | 2.3 km         |     | 3.6 km – 5.1 km  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Cost of water at source (20 litres)     |            | Ksh. 0-5       |     | Ksh. 0-10        |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | Utilization Indicators                  |            | Value          |     | Normal Range     |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | MUAC                                    |            | 8.5%           |     | 6.5% -9.2%       |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | CSI                                     |            | 5.7            |     | 4.9 – 7.8        |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                      |     |     |     |                          | FCS                                     | Acceptable | 79.0%          |     |                  |  |
| Borderline Poor                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 19.6%<br>1.4% |                      |     |     |     |                          |                                         |            |                |     |                  |  |
| Short rains harvest                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |               | Long rains           |     |     |     | Long rains harvest       |                                         |            |                |     |                  |  |
| Short dry spell                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               | Planting/weeding     |     |     |     | A long dry spell         |                                         |            |                |     |                  |  |
| Reduced milk yields                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |               | High calving rate    |     |     |     | Land preparation         |                                         |            |                |     |                  |  |
| Increased HH food stock                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |               | Milk yields increase |     |     |     | Increased HH food stocks |                                         |            |                |     |                  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               | ✓                    |     |     |     |                          |                                         |            |                |     |                  |  |
| Jan                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Feb           | Mar                  | Apr | May | Jun |                          | Jul                                     | Aug        | Sept           | Oct |                  |  |

Seasonal Calendar

## 1.0 CLIMATIC CONDITIONS

### 1.1 Rainfall Performance

In April, normally the peak of the March–May (MAM) season, rainfall reached 74.7 percent of the Long-Term average (LTA), with highly uneven dekadal distribution: Dekad 1 was very dry at 13.3 mm (26 percent of LTA), Dekad 2 near normal at 34.1 mm (89 percent of LTA), and Dekad 3 surging to 57.6 mm (132 percent of LTA), causing floods in Kamukuru, Kaputiei North, and Kajiado North that displaced about 100 households (Figure 1). Forecasts



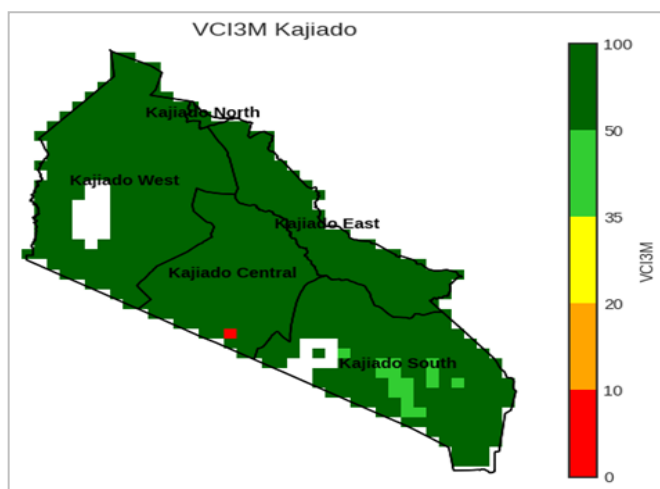
**Figure 1. Rainfall performance by dekad, Kajiado County.** Source: VAM-WFP

for the next 1–3 months suggest near to above average rainfall with cessation in late May, which will support pasture, water availability, and crop development in short term before the dry spell trigger declines in soil moisture and vegetation from June with risk of rise in food insecurity.

## 2.0 IMPACTS ON VEGETATION AND WATER

### 2.1 Vegetation Condition Index

The County 3-month Vegetation Condition Index (VCI) averaged 66.5 in April compared to 48.9 in March, indicating generally favorable vegetation conditions. This greenness persisted despite the highly uneven March–May long rains. Most sub-counties recorded above normal healthy vegetation as shown in figure 2, although parts of Kuku, Kimana wards experienced just normal conditions while parts of



**Figure 2: VCI 3 Months Map; Kajiado April 2026**

Matapato South experienced severe conditions. With rainfall expected to cease by late May, vegetation conditions are likely to begin declining in June as residual soil moisture diminishes. This is likely to trigger gradual deterioration of forage and water resources, risk of food insecurity

and vulnerability, particularly from June into the early dry season unless rainfall extends beyond the projected cessation period or timely drought mitigation measures are put in place.

## 2.2 Pasture and Browse Condition

Pasture and browse conditions across the County remained generally favorable, with 76.2 percent classified as good, although this marked a slight decline from 81.0 percent recorded in March due to reduced rainfall in late March and early April. The proportion of areas under fair pasture conditions increased to 23.8 percent from 19.0 percent, reflecting localized stress likely caused by the uneven spatial and temporal distribution of rainfall during the season. Conditions are likely to remain fair to good in May but may decline further to fair and, in some localized hotspots, poor by June and July, particularly in areas that received below-average rainfall, unless off-season rainfall is realized or mitigation measures are undertaken.

## 2.3 Water Access and Utilization

### 2.3.1 Water Sources

Water sources shifted notably in April compared to March, reflecting the impact of uneven rainfall distribution. Reliance on boreholes increased to 30.0 percent from 22.2 percent while pans and dams slightly declined to 29.1 percent from 33.3 percent in March, despite late heavy rains replenishing some surface storage (Figure 3). Piped water systems remained

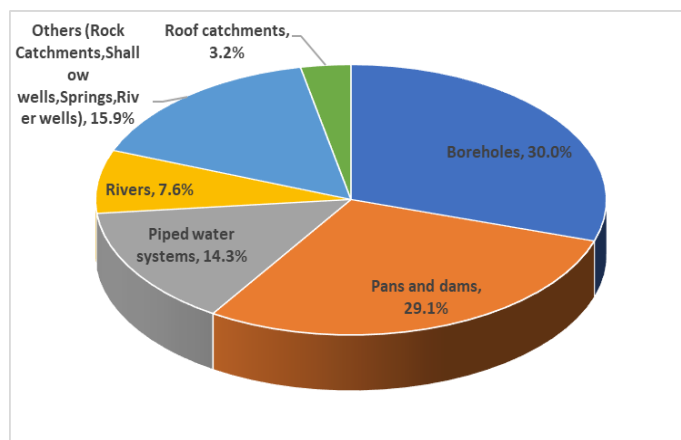


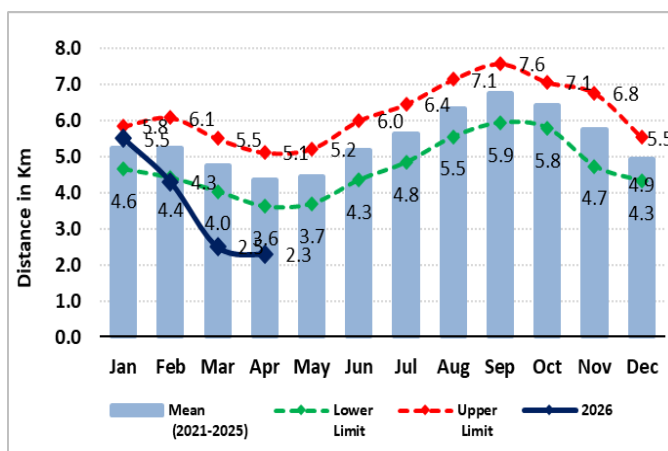
Figure 3. Main water sources; Kajiado, April 2026

stable at 14.3 percent, while roof catchments dropped sharply to 3.2 percent from 14.3 percent, likely due to variability in rainfall limiting effective household-level harvesting. Rivers increased to 7.6 percent from 4.8 percent while other sources (rock catchments, shallow wells, springs, traditional river wells) contributed 15.9 percent, down from 19.0 percent in March.

### 2.3.2 Water Access and Utilization by Households

The average return distance from households to main water points reduced to 2.3 km in April from 2.5 km in March, significantly below the normal range (3.6-5.1 km), reflecting enhanced accessibility due to recharge of communal sources following rainfall improvement in April (Figure 4). Pastoral households averaged 2.5 km, while agro-pastoral households averaged 2.3

km due to diverse water sources. Daily water consumption remained stable at 10–20 litres per person per day in pastoral areas and 15–25 litres in agro-pastoral areas. About 36 percent of households in Mbirikani, Kaputiei North, and Rombo wards purchased water in 20-liter jerrycans, at costs ranging from Ksh 3–10 per jerrican, with an additional Ksh 5 transport fee mainly reported in Kaputiei

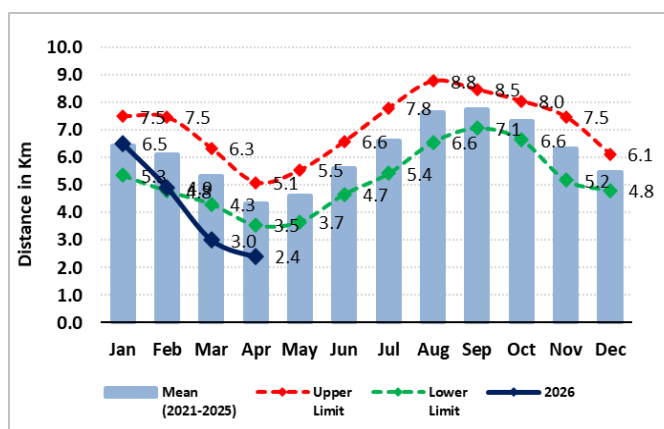


**Figure 4. Average return distance to water points from home; Kajiado, April 2026**

North, highlighting localized financial burdens. Overall, 60 percent of households treated their water, an improvement from 40 percent in March, using methods such as boiling (60 percent), filtration (13 percent), and water treatment chemicals (27 percent).

### 2.3.3 Livestock Access to Water

The April average return distance from livestock grazing areas to water sources was 2.4 km, a 20 percent decline from 3.0 km in March and below expected range, indicating improved access which enabled frequent livestock watering (Figure 5). The improvement was due to the availability of rain-fed water pools during the peak rainfall period providing



**Figure 5. Average return distance from grazing fields to water points; Kajiado April 2026**

closer alternatives other than the traditional points. Although these temporary pools are expected to dry as rains subside, potentially increasing trekking distances, the distance is likely to remain within normal in May as water pans and dams retain water. Livelihood variations were minimal since they both benefiting similarly. This has a positive short-term impact on food security, as reduced trekking distances help conserve livestock energy, improve body condition, and sustain milk production, supporting household nutrition and income.

## 3.0 PRODUCTION INDICATORS

### 3.1 Livestock Production

### 3.1.1 Livestock Body Condition

Livestock body condition in April was normal, with 66.7 percent in good condition, and 33.3 percent in moderate, representing a significant improvement from March, when 28.6 percent were good, 52.4 percent moderate, and 19.0 percent Borderline. This was attributed to enhanced pasture availability and water access following ongoing rains. However, April 2026 remains below April 2025 levels when 83.3 percent were good, and 16.7 percent moderate, reflecting the cumulative impact of rainfall deficit. Livelihood variations show pastoral zones specifically Rombo, Ewuaso Kedong, and Oldonyoinkies cattle exhibiting moderate body condition but with improving trend, likely due to late and slower regeneration due to uneven rainfall distribution.

### 3.1.2 Livestock Mortalities

In April 2026, there were no reports of unusual livestock mortalities due to drought.

### 3.1.3 Livestock Diseases

During April, endemic livestock diseases were reported mainly in Kajiado west, with Contagious Bovine Pleuropneumonia (CBPP) at 33 percent, Contagious Caprine Pleuropneumonia (CCPP) at 22 percent, Lumpy Skin Disease (LSD) at 19 percent, Peste des Petits Ruminants (PPR) at 15 percent and Foot and Mouth Disease at 11 percent. Ewuaso Kedong had the heaviest burden with four diseases (CBPP, CCPP, LSD, PPR), Loodokilani reported 33 percent PPR posing risk to small ruminants, and Oldonyonyokie was the sole location with 33 percent Foot and Mouth Disease. Actions taken included routine surveillance, and individual farmer antibiotic treatment.

### 3.1.4 Livestock Migration

No migration was reported in April as livestock remained in their wet season grazing areas.

### 3.1.5 Milk Production

The average milk production per household per day in April was 2.5 litres (Figure 6). Milk production rose from 2.1 litres in March to 2.5 litres in April, attributed to improved calving, and livestock body condition. The production was slightly below the five-year

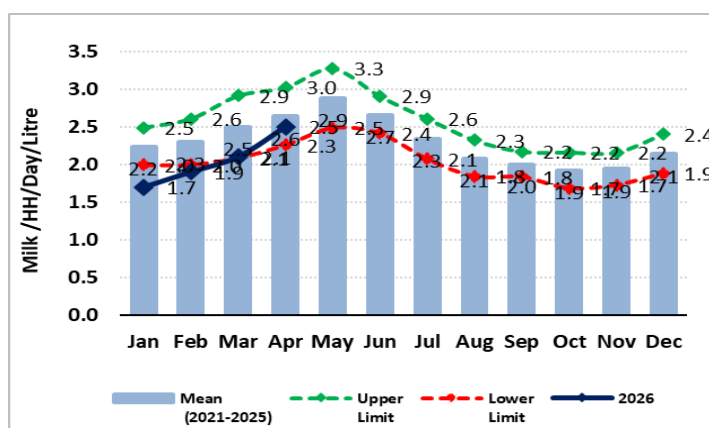


Figure 6. Average daily milk production; Kajiado, April 2026

average of 2.6 litres but falling within the expected range of 2.3–3.0 litres for this time of year. Kaputiei North recorded the highest production at 6.6 litres due to improved breeds while Loodokilani and Dalelekutuk recorded the lowest due to low calving rates and small herd sizes respectively. The difference was driven by breed quality, herd size, and calving.

### 3.2 Rain-Fed Crop Production

During the season, farmers mainly cultivated maize 40 percent, beans 40 percent, and cowpeas 20 percent. Crop conditions range from good to fair, with agro-pastoral areas experiencing waterlogging, while southern zones are recovering from moisture stress observed between late March and early April. Crop development varies across zones, beans are at podding and maize at tasseling in the south, while in agro-pastoral areas beans are at flowering and maize at knee-high stage, largely due to differences in planting time and rainfall distribution. No major pest or disease outbreaks have been reported, with continued emphasis on climate adaptation, soil conservation, and improved water management to support production.

## 4.0 MARKET PERFORMANCE

### 4.1 Livestock Marketing

Both livestock and foodstuff markets functioned smoothly, with major trading activity concentrated in Isinya, Ilbisil, Kimana, Ewuaso, Rombo, Mashurui, Shompole, and Kiserian.

#### 4.1.1 Cattle Prices

In April, cattle prices increased to Ksh 45,952 from Ksh 41,333 in March, reflecting improved livestock body conditions following favorable MAM rains, alongside reduced market supply as pastoralists shift towards herd rebuilding rather than selling (Figure 7). The lowest prices recorded in the pastoral zone of Ewaso Kedong at Ksh 32,000, while higher prices were observed in mixed and

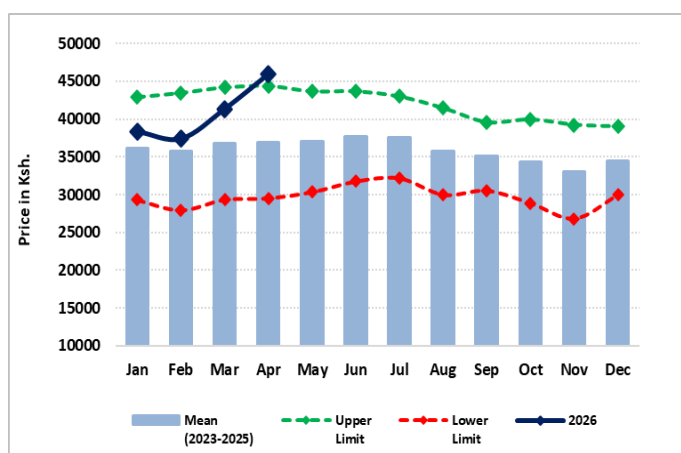


Figure 7. Average Cattle prices; Kajiado, April 2026

agro-pastoral areas due to better livestock conditions and stronger market access. Compared to the three-year average of Ksh 36,946, current price is above normal by approximately 24 percent, indicating favorable market environment.



### 4.1.2 Goats Prices

Goat prices increased slightly to an average Ksh 8,429 from Ksh 8,250 in March, indicating a modest upward trend likely driven by improved livestock body conditions, as well as increased market demand (Figure 8). The highest price was recorded in the pastoral area of Loodokilani at Ksh 10,000 and the lowest in the agro-pastoral area of Kaputiei North at Ksh

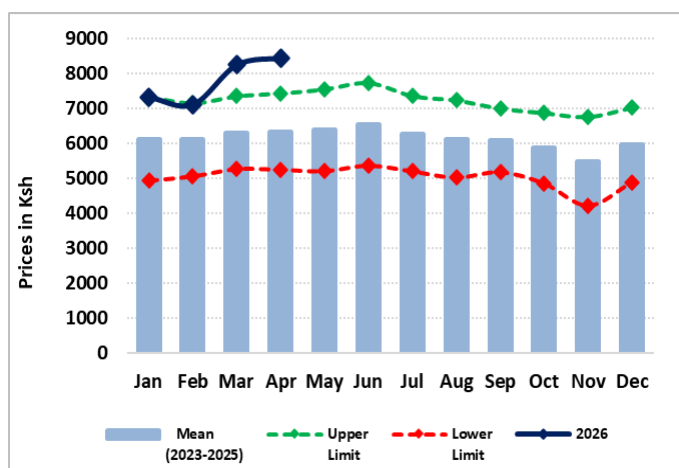


Figure 8. Average goat prices; Kajiado, April 2026

7,000; this difference was mainly attributed to breed type and stronger market demand in pastoral areas. Compared to the three-year average of Ksh 6,343, April prices are above normal by 33 percent, and also exceed the upper limit of Ksh 7,432, indicating that goat prices are significantly above the normal range for this time of year.

## 4.2 Prices of Cereals and Legumes

### 4.2.1 Maize Prices

Prices of several essential commodities increased in April 2026, with maize recording a slight rise to Ksh 82 per kilogram (kg) from Ksh 80 in March, mainly driven by sustained household demand and gradual stock drawdown (Figure 9). However, notable price disparities were observed across livelihood zones, with the highest prices in pastoral areas such as Ewuaso at Ksh

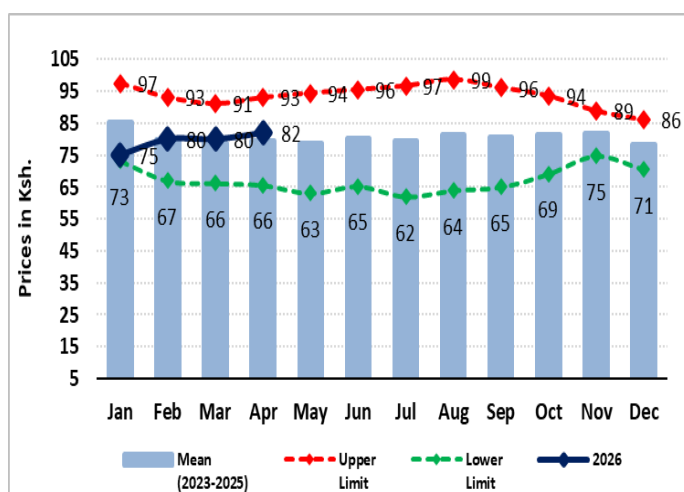


Figure 9. Average price of maize; Kajiado, April 2026

130 due to high dependence on market purchases and transport costs, while the lowest prices were recorded in mixed farming Loitoktok at Ksh 50, largely attributed to increase in supply due to cross-border maize inflows from Tanzania, where prices are significantly lower (Ksh 3,009 per 90kg bag compared to Ksh 3,800 in Kenya). Compared to the three-year average of Ksh 79, prices are slightly above normal by about 3.4 percent and remain within the seasonal range.

## 4.2.2 Beans Prices

In April, bean prices rose slightly to Ksh 153 per kilogram from Ksh 151 in March, driven by the pre-rainy season hungry gap when supply tightens before harvests, coupled with market shortages (Figure 10). Prices varied sharply across livelihood zones: pastoral areas of Mosiro and Ewuaso recorded the highest prices at Ksh 180 due to limited local production and reliance on imported supplies, while

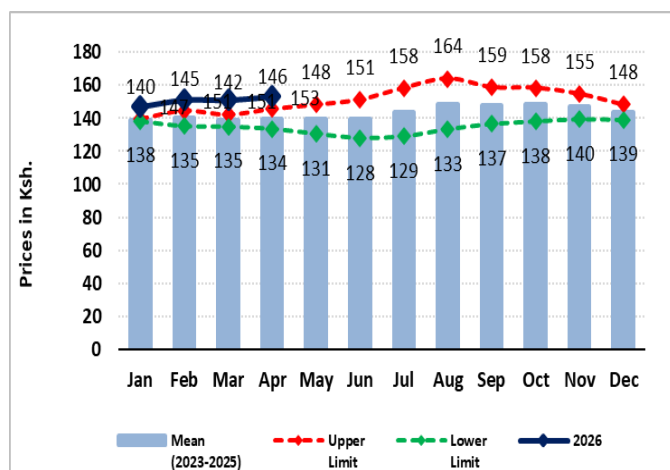


Figure 10. Average price of beans; Kajiado, April 2026

mixed farming areas in Loitoktok had the lowest at Ksh 100 due to better local harvests and market access. Compared to the three-year average of Ksh 140, April prices were 9.3 percent above normal and exceeded the upper threshold of Ksh 146, indicating prices are abnormally high for the time of year, largely because the pre-long-rains supply squeeze and March inflationary pressures have pushed markets beyond typical seasonal bounds.

## 4.3 Milk Prices

The average milk prices decreased to Ksh 70 in April from Ksh 75 in March, likely due to favorable grazing conditions, boosting lactation in herds and increasing market supply (Figure 11). No significant price variation was noted across livelihood zones, suggesting relatively uniform milk production and market integration throughout the county.

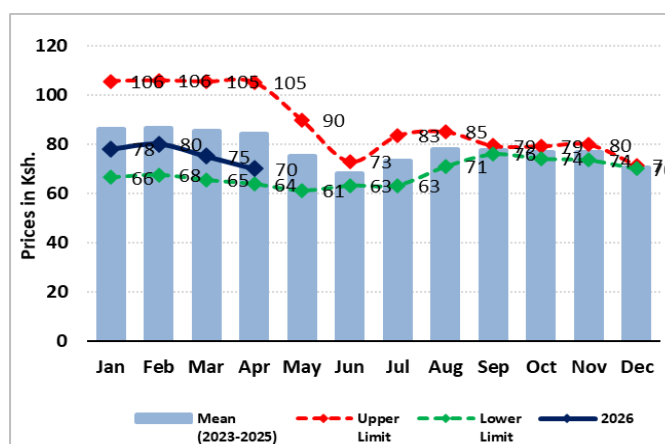


Figure 11. Average price of milk; Kajiado, April 2026

Compared to the three-year average of Ksh 84, prices were 16.7 percent below average; however, at Ksh 70, they still fall within the normal seasonal range of Ksh 64–105, indicating that while prices are lower than typical for April, they remain within normal for this time of year.

## 4.4 Terms of Trade

The Terms of Trade (ToT) in April slightly decreased to 102.8 kg of maize per sale of a medium



sized goat from March's 103.1 kg, primarily because the marginal increase in maize prices outweighed the modest gains in goat prices, thereby reducing the quantity of grain a pastoralist could purchase from the sale of one goat (Figure 12). ToT was highest in Rombo at 154.5 kg and lowest in Ewuaso Kedong at 61.8 kg; the higher ToT in Rombo, a border mixed farming area,

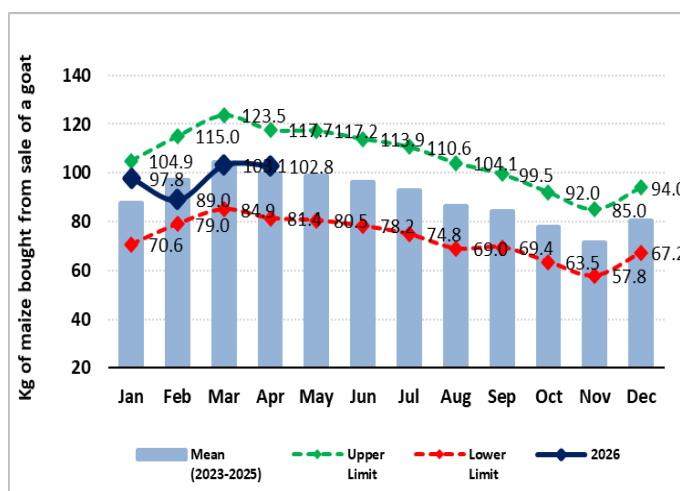


Figure 12. Terms of Trade; Kajiado, April 2026

was largely due to lower maize prices supported by cross-border inflows, while the lower ToT in Ewuaso Kedong, a pure pastoral zone, was driven by high maize prices despite improved goat values. Compared to the three-year average of 99.5 kg, April ToT is about 3 percent above average and remains comfortably within the normal range (81.4–117.7), indicating that terms of trade are generally stable and normal for this time of the year.

## 5.0 FOOD CONSUMPTION AND NUTRITION STATUS

### 5.1 Milk Consumption

In April, average household milk production was 2.5 liters per day, while average consumption stood at 1.6 liters per household per day, up from 1.4 liters in March, reflecting improved pasture and water access (Figure 13). Compared to the five-year average of 2.0 liters and the April 2025 level of 1.9 liters, consumption was 20 percent below average and lower than last year

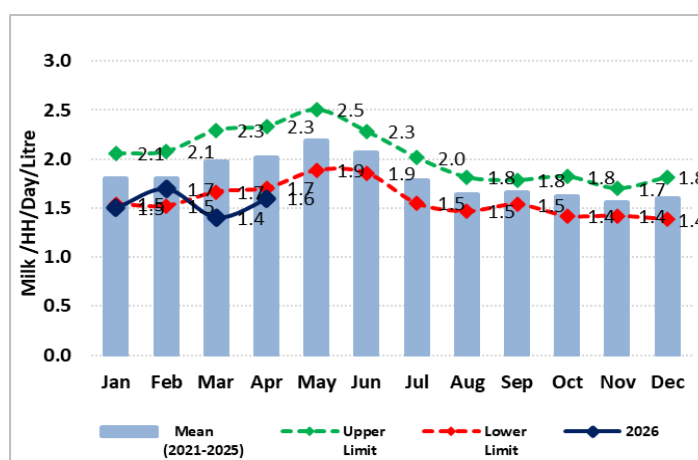
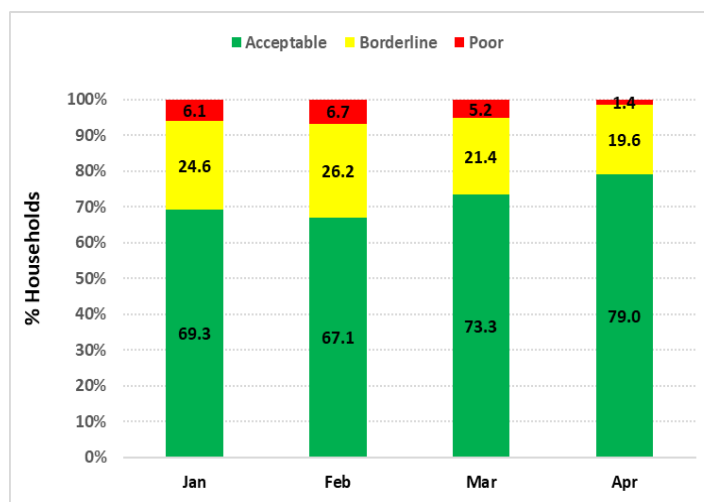


Figure 13. Household milk consumption; Kajiado, April 2026

despite similar production, largely because 64 percent of milk produced was sold, limiting household intake. Zone variations showed Kaputiei North and Ewuaso Kedong consuming above 2 liters, supported by higher production, while Dalalekutuk, Mbirikani, and Rombo recorded lower consumption at 1.2 liters due to low production from reduced calving. Overall, consumption rose month on month but remained below seasonal norms.

## 5.2 Food Consumption Score

As indicated in figure 14, the Food Consumption Score (FCS) showed 79 percent of households in the acceptable category, 19.5 percent borderline, and 1.4 percent poor, an improvement from March's 73.3 percent acceptable, 21.4 percent borderline, and 5.2 percent poor, but lower than April 2025's 84.4 percent acceptable, 15.6 percent borderline, and 0 percent poor. The mean FCS was



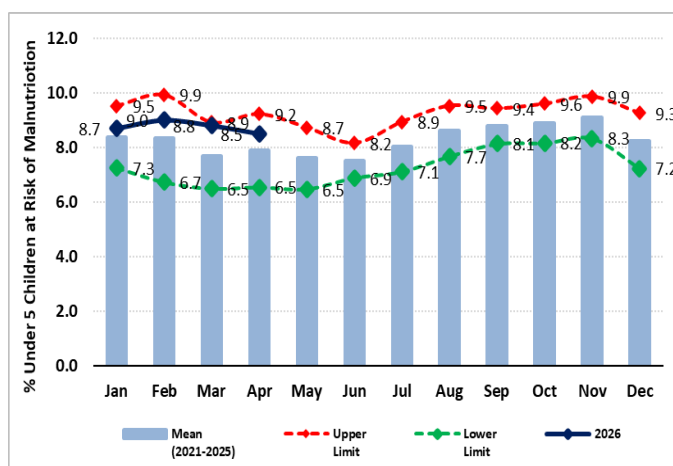
**Figure 14. % households per food consumption category; Kajiado, Jan to April 2026**

55.6, with agro pastoral households recording the highest at 67.1, while pastoral households had the lowest at 51.1, reflecting livelihood differences in dietary diversity, access to diverse food sources and underscoring persistent vulnerability among communities heavily reliant on livestock. The gains in April were supported by relatively stable Terms of Trade, and increased milk availability, though household consumption remained constrained as much of the milk was sold. Seasonal improvements from the long rains eased food access, but persistent maize price pressures and below average milk intake limited further gains, leaving overall consumption better than March yet still 5.4 percentage weaker than last year's seasonal norm.

## 5.3 Health And Nutrition Status

### 5.3.1 Nutrition Status of Children Aged 6-59 Months

The nutrition monitoring by Mid-Upper Arm Circumference (MUAC) of 882 children aged 6–59 months (396 females and 486 males) showed that 8.5 percent were at risk of malnutrition in April, with 7.8 percent of females and 9.1 percent of males affected, indicating slightly higher vulnerability among boys (Figure 15). This suggests a marginal improvement in MUAC status from March's 8.8 percent.



**Figure 15. % of under-fives at risk of malnutrition; Kajiado, April 2026**

Compared to the five-year April average of 7.9 percent and the expected range of 6.5–9.2 percent, current levels were above average but remained within the normal seasonal band, reflecting typical stress patterns and lingering vulnerability. By livelihood, the pastoral zone recorded a significantly higher burden at 9.7 percent compared to 5.6 percent in agro-pastoral areas. Loodokilani and Mbirikani reported concerning rates above 10 percent, followed by Ewuaso Kedong (9.5 percent) and Oldonyonyokie (9.2 percent), with Ewuaso Kedong’s situation compounded by a higher livestock disease burden. These patterns align with broader trends: modest improvements in milk consumption and Terms of Trade offered some nutritional support, but persistently high maize prices and the continued sale of most milk limited dietary gains, leaving child nutrition slightly improved from March but still below longer-term norms.

### 5.3.2 Health

The status of health of 882 children aged 6–59 months monitored showed that 91.2 percent reported no illness, while 8.2 percent experienced fever with chills resembling malaria and 0.7 percent had diarrhea. The highest diarrhea cases were concentrated in Oldonyonyokie, whereas fever with chills was widespread across the county but most pronounced in Dalalekutuk and Ewuaso Kedong. No major disease outbreaks were reported during the month. However, Kajiado West requires particular attention, as it faced both livestock and human disease challenges alongside elevated MUAC values, compounding vulnerability. Overall, child health remained relatively stable, but localized burdens in pastoral zones highlight the need for continued surveillance and targeted interventions

### 5.4 Coping Strategies Index

The mean reduced Coping Strategy Index (rCSI) for April was 5.7, indicating a slight improvement in food security compared to March’s 6.1. Although this was below the five-year average of 6.3, it remains notably higher than the April 2025 value of 4.4, while still falling within the normal seasonal range of 4.9–7.8 (Figure 16). Pastoral livelihood zones recorded a higher index

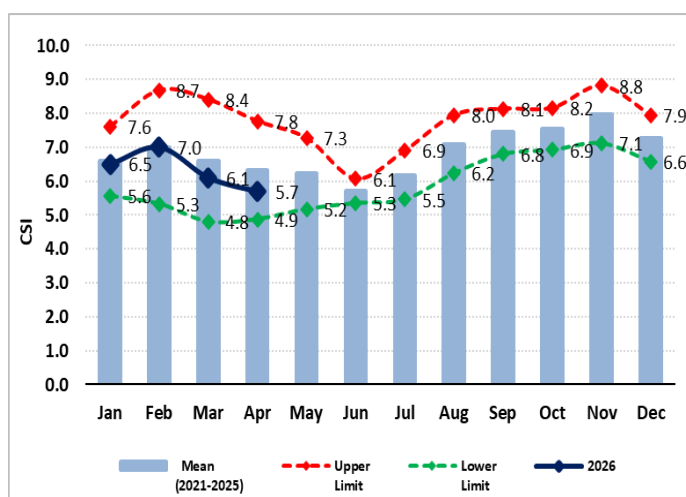


Figure 16. Coping strategy index; Kajiado, April 2026

of 6.5 compared to 3.6 in agro-pastoral areas, pointing to greater food stress among livestock-dependent households. In terms of coping prevalence, dietary quality substitution was nearly universal, with 90.0 percent of households relying on less preferred foods. More severe consumption-based strategies were also observed, with 42.9 percent reducing the number of meals, 37.6 percent reducing portion sizes, 13.3 percent restricting adult consumption, and 5.7 percent borrowing food. These patterns reflect underlying economic pressures, with households likely adjusting consumption to preserve limited income in the face of high maize prices, only modest improvements in Terms of Trade, and the continued prioritization of milk sales over household consumption.

## **6.0 FOOD SECURITY PROGNOSIS**

The food security prognosis for May–July 2026 indicates mixed outcomes. Rainfall forecasts suggest near to above average conditions until late May, supporting short term improvements in pasture regeneration, water availability, and crop development, thereby enhancing food access and stabilizing livestock productivity. However, cessation of rains by late May will likely trigger declines in soil moisture and vegetation from June, with the Vegetation Condition Index (VCI) expected to fall from April’s favorable 66.5 as residual greenness diminishes. This will gradually reduce forage and water resources, increasing household and livestock stress into the dry season. Livestock body condition, currently good, may weaken, milk production could decline, and household water access may deteriorate. Crop prospects remain fair to good, but uneven rainfall distribution and localized flooding may disrupt yields in vulnerable wards.

Food security risks will be compounded by localized disease burdens and food insecurity. Kajiado West requires particular attention due to concurrent livestock and human disease challenges and high MUAC values. Wards such as Kamukuru, Kaputiei North, and Kajiado North already affected by April floods face heightened vulnerability, while Ewuaso Kedong shows peculiar stress patterns with high maize prices, heavy livestock disease burden, and elevated child malnutrition. If insecurity or migration intensifies during the dry season, household coping strategies may worsen, with pastoral zones most exposed given their higher reliance on markets and longer trekking distances once surface water declines. Overall, while short term gains from April rains have eased conditions, the forecasted dry spell and localized shocks point to rising vulnerability from June onward, requiring close monitoring and targeted interventions.

## 7.0 ONGOING INTERVENTIONS

- Joint Kenya–Tanzania vaccination exercise launched with supported from the EU-PLACE Project and IGAD–ICPALD, for PPR in goats and sheep to curb transboundary disease spread during the rainy season.
- Launch of the VITAL 2 initiative supported by County Government and Kenya Veterinary Association and GALVmed. This pilot aims to modernize vaccine distribution through private-sector networks to reach "last-mile" pastoralist farmers.
- Routine surveillance and farmer-level antibiotic treatments.
- UNESCO session with local partners under the "Transforming MEN'talities" initiative to address gender-based violence and promote equality within pastoral communities.
- The County Project Steering Committee for the National Agricultural Value Chain Development Project (NAVCDP) approved high-impact investments to accelerate livestock commercialization and resilience.

## 8.0 RECOMMENDED OPTIONS INTERVENTIONS

- ✓ Scale Up Targeted Livestock Disease Control and Disease Surveillance with priority for Kajiado West; *By County Veterinary services and Partners.*
- ✓ Enhance Integrated Nutrition and Health Outreaches; *By County Department of Health Services and Partners.*
- ✓ Promote Fodder Preservation and Silage Production especially now when pasture and browse is available and encourage grazing fields' management as we transition to dry conditions; *By County Livestock Production and partners.*
- ✓ Provision of water treatment kits and strengthen water resource management and access; *By County Water Services and partners.*
- ✓ Community resilience building such as value chain developments and tree planting; *By County government and partners.*

**This report was verified by:**

**County Drought Coordinator; Kajiado County**

**Name...Hussein Alio.... Sign...**



**..... Date...05/05/2026.....**